united under one flag. Maybe the pride Americans take in their country is one of the reasons why sports stars here seem to enjoy a level of respect that's not always the case in Europe. Heroes of mine like Michael Jordan, Tiger Woods, Andre Agassi and Michael Johnson have been pushed onto greater achievement, I'd say, because they know they've got the unqualified support of the whole country behind them when they go into action.

Those sporting greats—and the rappers who are the soundtrack to my days and nights, too, for that matter—have taken advantage of being born and raised in the land of opportunity. The American Dream is founded on the same principles as my own: if you work hard enough, there never needs to be a limit on how far life can take you. I was born loving soccer and, thanks to my parents, team-mates, school teachers and coaches, I've been able to experience some amazing things over the past 28 years.

Both Feet On The Ground is the story of how that happened: playing for a decade at the club I supported as a boy; captaining my country at soccer's biggest tournament, the World Cup; and, now, beginning a new journey with the most successful team in the history of the game. Alongside my career, I've got a tale of the heart I want to tell as well: a love affair that's given me the marriage and family that make David Beckham feel complete.

Opportunity; hard work; the love of my wife and family. I hope it's a story that every American will be able to recognize. Even if this one's written by a very English guy. I hope you'll enjoy it.

David Beckham
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